AI IN GOVERNMENT AND PUBLIC SERVICES - VOLUME 9

The Workforce, Ethics and Public Trust Playbook

Skilled people, visibly in charge, ethics that can say no - with AI that prepares, drafts and flags, and public servants who serve, decide and answer.



Gates W0-W5 | 8 Templates | 20 Golden Rules

The worked example continues: **Northbridge City and County**, a fictional composite government of 480,000 residents, now seen through its 6,200 staff - caseworkers, planners, revenue officers, call-takers, inspectors and the managers who lead them. Every figure attached to Northbridge is illustrative. Adapt thresholds to your own law, labour agreements and risk appetite.

Executive / Service / Accountability lenses on every major section, so a chief executive, a frontline officer and a resident can read the same page and each find their decision.

START HERE

Trust is not a mood. It is a working condition

Every earlier volume assumed two things: staff who can use AI well, and a public willing to believe them. This volume builds both. A frightened, deskilled workforce produces defensive, rubber-stamped AI. A public that learns about AI from a scandal, rather than from the service itself, withdraws the consent every other volume spends.

How to use this playbook

- **Executives and elected members** read pages 4, 7, 20 and 29, and hold the stop list personally.
- **People and HR leads** read pages 5, 9-11 and 18-22 first; roles, skills and pace are designed there.
- **Ethics reviewers and auditors** start at pages 12-14, 23 and 29-32.
- **Frontline teams** read pages 11, 16 and 17 - the override, the explanation and the apology.

The one test that matters

Every design choice answers one question: **would a skilled officer, and the resident they serve, both say this made the service more human where it counts and more honest where it matters?** Efficiency that costs either answer is not efficiency; it is trust spent as savings, and the bill arrives as vacancies, complaints and refusal to engage.

AI prepares, drafts and flags. People serve, decide and answer. **Trust is earned by the people, in public, or not at all.**

EXECUTIVE LENS

Own staff confidence and public trust alongside savings; they are the savings' licence to exist.

SERVICE LENS

A resident is served when a named person can explain, decide and put things right.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Every claim made in public about AI must be checkable in public - register, data, audit.

THE SERIES

Where this volume sits

Vol	Title	Owns
1	Strategy	Mandate, portfolio, risk tiers, gates S0-S5
2	Citizen Services and Digital Front Doors	Find, understand, apply, track, contact
3	Benefits, Licensing and Casework	Eligibility support, evidence, caseworker tools
4	Permitting, Planning and Land Use	Applications, completeness, inspections
5	Tax, Revenue and Compliance	Filing support, assessments, proportionate checks
6	Procurement and Supplier AI	Buying, contracts, model and supplier governance
7	Emergency Services and Public Safety	Dispatch support, triage, public alerts
8	Data, Records and Interoperability	Registers, records, sharing, retention
9	Workforce, Ethics and Public Trust	Roles, skills, ethics review, public reporting (this volume)
10	Government Capstone and Assurance	Whole-portfolio assurance and the licence to scale

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TRUST

Trust is the licence every other volume spends

Residents cannot opt out of government. They cannot take their benefits, permits or tax affairs to a competitor, so their trust is not a market signal - it is a democratic one. Lose it and the costs are concrete: forms returned half-empty, advice ignored, consultations boycotted, staff abused, and every honest service redesign read as a trick.

What trust is made of

- **Competence:** decisions are right, letters are accurate, systems work. AI raises competence only where accuracy is measured (Volumes 2-8); unmeasured AI lowers it at scale.
- **Honesty:** the service says what AI does, where it errs and what it will never do - before being asked, in the register (p14).
- **Benevolence:** residents believe the service is on their side. That belief is built by frontline staff who have time, discretion and support - a workforce question before it is a communications one.
- **Answerability:** a named person can explain, apologise and put things right (p17, 20). Anonymous systems cannot be trusted because they cannot answer.

Trust is a **stock, not a flow**: built slowly by kept promises, spent quickly by hidden ones. Budget for it accordingly.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Never announce trust. Publish the evidence - accuracy, overturns, complaints - and let trust be the conclusion residents draw.

SERVICE LENS

Low trust is information about the service, not a defect in the public. Treat survey anger as casework about the institution.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Trust in AI follows trust in the institution, not the reverse. Fix the institution's promises first.

THE WORKFORCE

Northbridge's 6,200 people, honestly described

Change programmes fail on a fantasy workforce: endlessly adaptable, digitally confident, waiting to be transformed. Northbridge's real workforce (illustrative) is experienced, stretched, ageing in some crafts and churning in others - and it holds, in its heads, most of what the AI is supposed to learn.

Workforce fact (illustrative)	Figure	Design consequence
Median service length	11 years	Tacit knowledge is the training asset; capture it with staff, never from them
Vacancy rate, hard-to-fill crafts	9-14%	AI that adds work will be abandoned; subtraction comes first (p18)
Staff who have used AI at work	38%	Literacy starts from real, uneven experience - not zero, not fluency (p10)
Staff confident AI will help their role	44%	Confidence is earned per tool, per team; there is no org-wide announcement fix
Managers spanning 12+ reports	1 in 3 teams	Leading change (p21) needs span relief, not exhortation

- **Describe the workforce before redesigning it.** Skills, vacancies, age profile, absence, grievances and exit reasons, by service - the baseline every later claim is measured against (p23).
- **Protect scarce crafts first.** Planners, investigators, safeguarding leads: AI plans start from retaining and growing these people, not from headcount arithmetic.
- **Name the fear honestly.** Staff assume headcount is the goal until proven otherwise. The proof is behavioural: what leaders fund, measure and celebrate (p9, 24).

EXECUTIVE LENS

A workforce plan written without workforce data is a hope with a Gantt chart.

SERVICE LENS

Exit interviews are evaluation data. Read them in the AI programme board, not only in HR.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Agency and contractor spend is part of the workforce picture; hiding it there breaks trust inside and out.

THE OPPORTUNITY

Where AI pays: time returned, judgement deepened, trust evidenced

Use	What AI does	Trust it builds
Preparation at scale	Summaries, extraction, drafting across Volumes 2-8	Officers arrive informed; residents meet a person, not a queue
Coaching and practice	Simulated cases, feedback on drafts, safe rehearsal	New staff reach competence faster, supervised honestly
Ethics and fairness tooling	Bias scans, outcome-pattern dashboards, register automation	Reviewers see the whole portfolio, not the loudest case
Workforce insight	Aggregated workload, vacancy and skills signals	Managers act on overload before it becomes absence
Public evidence	Plain-language accuracy, audit and engagement reporting	Claims in public match records in private (p14)
Knowledge capture	Senior practitioners' methods turned into cited guidance	Departing expertise stays, credited to its authors

Where the return actually sits

- **Time returned to judgement.** The dividend of every earlier volume is hours. This volume decides what those hours become: deeper casework, supervision, learning - or an invisible headcount cut that teaches staff the dividend was a trap.
- **Consistency residents can feel.** Like cases handled alike, explanations that match across channels, promises kept at the same standard in every office.
- **Evidence, published.** Each use case adds to a public record of accuracy and fairness that compounds into the licence Volume 10 will test.

> **The dividend rule:** time saved by AI is allocated in advance, in writing, with staff representatives (p19) - a stated share to service quality, learning and backlog, before any share to savings.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Bank the dividend visibly or lose adoption invisibly; staff do the arithmetic either way.

SERVICE LENS

A use case with no workforce story has no adoption story, however good the model.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Trust returns are slow and compounding; report them on the same horizon as the investment.

THE STOP LIST

Decisions about people that AI never makes

Earlier volumes stopped AI at the resident-facing decisions: eligibility, enforcement, penalties, dispatch. This volume draws the same line inside the house, and one line in public. These are not settings to tune; they are exclusions, signed at W0, taught to every manager, and breach-logged like a safety incident.

Never automated	Why	What AI may do instead
Discipline, dismissal or capability verdicts	Livelihood decisions need accountable human judgement and due process	Assemble the record; a manager decides and answers
Individual performance scores or rankings	Surveillance scoring corrodes the candour safe services run on	Team-level, aggregated workload insight (p23)
Hiring, promotion or redeployment selection	Public employers must show fair, challengeable selection (p22)	Screen for completeness; people shortlist and decide
Ethics approval of its own use cases	A system cannot grant itself a licence	Prepare evidence; the ethics board decides (p12)
Monitoring of staff communications or movement	Trust cannot be built by watching the trusted	Nothing. Excluded, not minimised
Public trust scoring of residents or neighbourhoods	Ranking citizens by predicted cooperativeness is discrimination with a dashboard	Engagement insight in aggregate, published (p15)
Final answers to complaints or appeals	Redress is a human act of accountability (p17)	Draft the chronology; an officer decides and signs

A stop-list breach is a **programme incident**: pause the use, tell affected staff or residents, record it in the register, review at the board.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Hold this list personally. Delegated, it becomes negotiable under delivery pressure.

SERVICE LENS

Recruitment and HR vendors are held to this list contractually (p27), not by hope.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Any manager can invoke the stop list without career cost. That protection is the policy, not a poster.

PRINCIPLES

Ten design principles for people, ethics and trust

1. **People decide, visibly.** Every consequential output names its human decider, inside and outside the house.
2. **Subtraction before addition.** No AI tool lands until work it replaces is actually removed from the day.
3. **The dividend is shared in advance.** Time saved is allocated in writing before rollout, with staff representatives.
4. **Skill is the safety case.** No one operates a tool they have not been trained and assessed to challenge.
5. **Disagreement is data.** Overrides, complaints and grievances are read as evidence about the system first.
6. **Nothing about us, scored about us.** No individual surveillance or scoring of staff or residents (p7).
7. **Ethics can stop the line.** Review has a veto, time to use it, and a public record of using it.
8. **Say it before you are asked.** Uses, limits, errors and failures are published on the service's own timetable.
9. **Repair beats reputation.** When trust breaks, fix the harm and the cause before managing the story (p26).
10. **Trust is measured like money.** Baselines, instruments, owners and consequences - or it is a slogan (p23).

Applying the principles

Principles earn their page at gate W1: each use case records, principle by principle, how its design complies or why it claims an exception - and exceptions are decided by the ethics board, not the delivery team. A principle that has never stopped anything is decoration; the board reports annually how often each principle changed a design (p12).

> **The corridor test:** state the use case in one sentence to a frontline officer and to a resident. If either sentence needs footnotes to sound acceptable, the design is not ready.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Principles are a procurement and design tool, not a comms asset; keep them out of the brochure until they have bitten.

SERVICE LENS

Review the principles yearly against real cases, and amend in public.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Ten kept principles beat thirty laminated ones.

ROLES

Roles redesigned, not removed - and redesigned with their holders

AI changes tasks faster than it changes jobs, and panic comes from confusing the two. The redesign standard works task by task, with the people who do them, and publishes the result before any tool goes live in that service.

The redesign standard

- **Task inventory first.** For each role: tasks automated, tasks augmented, tasks untouched, and tasks newly created - review, correction, explanation, ethics evidence. Most roles gain skilled tasks; say which, specifically.
- **Job content re-agreed, not announced.** New role profiles, queue weighting and quality expectations are negotiated with holders and representatives (p19) before rollout, not consulted on after.
- **Time visibly reallocated.** Rosters show where saved hours went - supervision, complex cases, learning, outreach. If the roster does not change, staff will assume the worst, correctly.
- **No compulsory-redundancy surprise.** Where an organisation can honestly commit to transition through vacancies and retraining, it commits in writing with a horizon; where it cannot, it says so early and funds fair transition. Ambiguity is the cruellest option.
- **Scarce-craft growth paths.** Review, investigation, rules and ethics work become graded specialisms with pay progression (p25), so expertise has somewhere to go besides management.



Teams redesigning their own work: tasks mapped together before any tool arrives, managers in the room as participants.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Role redesign done to staff will be undone by staff, quietly and effectively.

SERVICE LENS

Publish role impacts service by service; organisation-wide averages hide the team that loses everything.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Retraining offers must lead to real vacancies, or they read as exit management with better branding.

SKILLS

AI literacy: the licence to challenge, issued to every role

Level	Who	Assessed on
Use	Every member of staff	What the tools do and never do (p7); checking outputs; when to escalate
Challenge	Frontline and casework roles	Spotting plausible errors, missing evidence and stale data in real case patterns
Decide	Decision-makers and signatories	Confidence, limits and the record: signing only what they can defend (p11)
Review	Ethics, fairness and audit roles	Outcome-pattern reading, sampling, gate evidence (p12-13, 29)
Build and assure	Data, digital and supplier-facing roles	Evaluation design, change control, exit and records (Volume 8, p27)

- **Practical, on real work.** Training uses the service's own case patterns, documents and failure examples - including AI outputs that are confidently wrong, because recognising those is the core skill.
- **Time is rostered, not squeezed.** Literacy hours sit inside the working week with cover arranged; training done in staff's own time announces how little the change is valued.
- **Confidence is measured, not assumed.** Short pulse checks and observed practice, by team, shape coaching. Low confidence after training is feedback on the training and the tools.
- **Champions are practitioners.** Peer coaches are respected operators with protected time, not enthusiasts with a second unpaid job.

Nobody signs what they cannot challenge. **Training precedes access, assessment precedes sign-off rights.**

EXECUTIVE LENS

Fund literacy as safety training, with the same non-negotiable status and refresh cycle.

SERVICE LENS

A workforce that cannot describe a tool's failure modes cannot safely hold its stop list.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Literacy decays as models change; every material model change triggers a refresh (p27).

JUDGEMENT

Professional judgement and the protected override

Every volume in this series ends its chain at a human decision. This page protects that human. An override that costs time, invites questions or dents a dashboard will quietly disappear - and with it, the entire assurance model of the series.

The override standard

- **One action, no permission.** Any officer can set aside any AI output, at the point of work, without seeking approval. The system records the override and the reason in the officer's own words.
- **Reasons are read for learning.** Override patterns are reviewed monthly as evidence about the tool, the data and the training - in that order. Individual officers are not performance-managed on override rates.
- **Agreement is also sampled.** Assurance reads cases where officers agreed with the AI, not only where they did not; a 98 percent agreement rate is investigated as a warning, not celebrated as adoption.
- **Thinking time is designed in.** Queues and targets assume reading, checking and deciding. A desk optimised to remove every pause manufactures rubber stamps (Volumes 3, 5, 7).
- **The signature means something.** Signatories attest they reviewed the evidence the record lists. Batch signing is a disciplinary matter - for the system that demanded it, first.

> **Northbridge (illustrative):** a benefits team's override rate rose after training, then fell as two extraction defects it exposed were fixed. The board now reads rising overrides as the training working, and funds fixes accordingly.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Publish the override rate next to accuracy. Together they describe a healthy desk; separately, each misleads.

SERVICE LENS

Protect the first officer who overrides a flagship tool in a flagship service. Everyone is watching what happens to them.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

If overrides cluster on one resident group, treat it as a fairness signal and route it to page 13.

ETHICS

Ethics review that can say no - and sometimes does

An ethics process that approves everything is worse than none: it lends legitimacy it has not earned. Northbridge's ethics board is built to be capable of refusal - independent membership, evidence standards, time in the schedule, and a public record.

Board element	Standard
Membership	Service, legal, data and frontline members, plus independent and resident members with full voting rights; conflicts declared and minuted
Evidence	Gate packs (p29) with accuracy by group, stop-list check, workforce impact, engagement record - read before the meeting, tested in it
Powers	Approve, condition, pause or refuse any use case; conditions carry owners and dates; a pause needs no delivery-board permission
Record	Decisions, conditions, dissents and refusals published in the register (p14) within a set number of days
Cadence	Reviews at W0, W3 and W5, plus triggered review on incidents, drift or material model change

- **Refusals are reported without spin.** An annual ethics report that lists what was refused or conditioned, and why, is the strongest trust document the service publishes.
- **Resident members are supported, not decorative.** Payment, papers in plain language, and training equal to staff members - or their presence is a photograph, not a voice.
- **Escalation goes up, not around.** A delivery team that disagrees appeals to the executive with the board's record attached; it does not re-scope the use case to dodge the question.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Staff the board for scepticism; a board of project sponsors will find every project ethical.

SERVICE LENS

The board's budget and secretariat are independent of the programmes it reviews.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Measure the board by conditions enforced and harms prevented, not meetings held.

FAIRNESS

Fairness review: bias found is bias fixed, in public view

Each service volume runs its own equity checks. This page owns the cross-portfolio discipline: one method, one cadence, one escalation route - so a disparity found anywhere teaches everywhere.

The fairness standard

- **Outcomes, not intentions.** Reviews compare decisions, burdens, waits, errors and overturns by group, channel, language and place - for residents and, with the same seriousness, for staff in internal tools (p22).
- **Small numbers handled honestly.** Where groups are small, reviews pool periods, protect confidentiality, and say what could not be concluded - rather than declaring fairness from silence.
- **A disparity is a defect ticket.** Each finding gets an owner, a hypothesis (data, model, process or practice), a fix or a reasoned acceptance signed by the ethics board - and a re-test date.
- **Lived experience is evidence.** Panels of affected residents and staff review samples and wording alongside the statistics; panels are paid, rotated and told what changed because of them.
- **Publication by default.** Fairness findings join the register in plain language (p14), including the uncomfortable ones. A review the public cannot see cannot reassure the public.

Fairness work ends in a **changed decision pattern or a published reason** - never in a workshop.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Give the fairness review authority to pause a use case; a review that cannot stop anything is theatre.

SERVICE LENS

Budget re-testing at the start. Fixes nobody re-measures are hopes.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Disaggregate staff fairness too: who gets flagged, believed and promoted inside the house is part of public trust.

TRANSPARENCY

The public account: one register, kept current, written for residents

Volumes 2-8 each kept a service register. This volume owns the single public account they feed: one place where a resident, a journalist or a councillor can find every AI use, its owner, its evidence and its failures - without a freedom-of-information request.

Register field	Content
Use and owner	What each AI does, in which service, accountable owner by role and name
Human decision point	Where a person decides, and how a resident reaches that person
Evidence	Latest accuracy and fairness results, with dates and sample sizes
Workforce impact	Roles changed, dividend allocation (p8), training status per service
Incidents and failures	Stop-list breaches, outages and corrections, with what was repaired (p26)
Ethics record	Board decisions, conditions, refusals and dissents (p12)
Suppliers	Vendor, model version, change notices and exit status (p27)

- **Currency is the standard.** Entries carry review dates; an overdue entry flags itself publicly rather than quietly ageing.
- **Plain language is tested.** Register text is read by the resident panel (p13) before publication. If they cannot explain it back, it is rewritten.
- **Failures publish on the same cadence as successes.** Separate channels for good and bad news is how registers become brochures.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Write the register for a resident holding a wrong letter. If it does not help them, rewrite it.

SERVICE LENS

Link the register from every AI-assisted letter and page; transparency nobody can find is filing.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Audit the register against reality yearly; a wrong entry is a trust incident, not a typo.

ENGAGEMENT

Public engagement: ask early, publish what changed

Stage	Engagement standard	Evidence it happened
Before mandate (W0)	Residents and staff hear the problem and the options, including not using AI	Published summary of views, including opposition
Design (W1-W2)	Co-design panels test wording, channels and safeguards with affected groups	Change log: what panels altered, what was refused and why
Proof (W3)	Panel members read real (anonymised) outputs and fairness results	Panel statement filed with the gate record
Live (W4-W5)	Standing panel reviews incidents, complaints themes and register entries	Minutes and service responses published

- **Recruit beyond the usual voices.** Deliberate outreach to digitally excluded residents, minority-language communities and disability groups - with access support and payment as standard.
- **Disagreement is recorded, not managed.** Where the service proceeds against panel advice, it publishes its reasons beside the advice. Consent manufactured by selective minutes collapses on first contact with the minutes' authors.
- **Engagement is not a launch event.** The panel's busiest moments should be incidents and failures (p26), when trust is actually decided.



Engagement as a standing institution: residents and officers in a circle, deciding together - not a consultation photograph.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Ask what would make you trust this, then publish the answer and the response side by side.

SERVICE LENS

Fund engagement inside the programme budget; unfunded engagement is a press release with chairs.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Close every engagement loop in writing, or do not open the next one.

THE FRONTLINE

Explaining AI at the counter, on the phone, at the door

For most residents, the service's AI policy is whatever the officer in front of them says in the next thirty seconds. Equip that officer: honest lines, real discretion, and permission never to hide behind the system.

The explanation standard

- **Say it plainly, first.** "A computer programme helped prepare your case summary. I read it, I checked it against your documents, and the decision is mine." Tested wording lives in a shared phrase bank - as a floor for honesty, not a script against judgement.
- **Never say "the computer decided".** It is false under this series' model, and staff are backed by management when they correct it - including when a resident prefers to blame the machine.
- **Offer the human route without penalty.** A resident who asks for human-only handling gets it, recorded without detriment. The volume of such requests is published: it is a trust metric, not an inconvenience (p23).
- **Know the next step.** Every frontline worker can state the correction, complaint and appeal routes from memory, and can start them on the resident's behalf.
- **Feed the phrases back.** Lines that confuse or inflame are reported and the phrase bank fixed monthly; frontline staff edit it, comms publishes it.

> **The test:** after the conversation, can the resident say who decided, on what evidence, and what they can do if it is wrong? If not, the explanation failed - however warm it felt.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Role-play the hard conversations in training, with actors if you can; policy PDFs do not survive contact with an angry queue.

SERVICE LENS

Do not discipline staff for honest explanations that make headlines; discipline the conditions that made the headline true.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Monitor explanation quality by listening to real calls with consent, sampled - the consent and sampling are part of the standard.

REDRESS

Complaints, redress and the craft of trust repair

A complaint is the trust system working at retail scale: one resident, one failure, one chance to demonstrate what the institution is. AI makes failures faster and wider; redress must be equally deliberate.

The repair standard

- **Easy to start, in any channel, registered the same day.** AI assembles the chronology and evidence pack; a named officer owns the case (Template 7).
- **Remedy before explanation.** Correct the record, refund the money, rebook the appointment first - then explain. Explanations offered before remedies read as excuses with citations.
- **Apologise specifically.** What happened, what it cost the resident, what changed because of it. "Lessons have been learned" without the lessons named is a second offence.
- **Systemic causes escalate automatically.** Cause-coded complaints (the discipline of Volumes 3 and 5) feed the fairness review and the ethics board; a pattern is a programme problem, not a run of difficult residents.
- **Repaired trust is measured.** Follow up a sample of complainants: was it put right, would they use the service again willingly? Report the answers beside complaint volumes.

Never set a target to reduce complaints. **Reduce the causes; complaints are a right in use and a sensor you did not have to build.**

EXECUTIVE LENS

Complaint handling is a senior craft. Staff it and grade it accordingly; it is where the institution's character is audited daily.

SERVICE LENS

Publish complaint themes and fixes on the register's cadence (p14).

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

A complainant who is proved right about a systemic issue gets thanked in writing. Mean it.

WELLBEING

Wellbeing, workload and the honest pace of change

Change fatigue is not resistance; it is a workload signal. Services that stack AI rollout on top of winter pressures, system replacements and vacancy gaps will get neither the AI nor the service - and will lose the staff both needed.

The pace standard

- **One change load budget per team.** All initiatives - AI and otherwise - draw on a single, visible change capacity per service, sequenced by the people who carry the caseload.
- **Subtraction is scheduled.** Every go-live names the reports, duplicate entries and checks that stop that week (p8). Additions without subtractions are how tools become burdens with logins.
- **Workload is monitored in aggregate.** Queue lengths, overtime, absence and after-hours system use at team level - reviewed with representatives (p19), acted on visibly, never drilled into individuals (p7).
- **Emotional labour is recognised.** AI takes the transcription; humans keep the bereavement call, the safeguarding visit, the furious resident. Rosters and supervision reflect that concentration of hard work, not just its volume.
- **Permission to slow down is real.** A manager can pause a rollout for capacity reasons without it counting against them; the pause and reason are recorded at W4 like any other evidence.

> **Northbridge (illustrative):** sequencing two rollouts a quarter apart, with the duplicate case note retired at the first go-live, cut overtime in the pilot service by a fifth - and the second rollout adopted faster than the first.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Burnout in a pilot team is a failed pilot, whatever the accuracy figures say.

SERVICE LENS

Wellbeing metrics sit in the gate pack. A W4 with red absence data does not pass on green model data.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Protect the teams nobody photographs: back-office and night staff carry change too.

PARTNERSHIP

Working with staff representatives: early, formal, in writing

Staff representatives - unions and recognised associations - are not a consultation audience; in most public employers they are a formal party to changes in work. Programmes that treat them as a comms channel discover the formal rights later, at higher cost.

The partnership standard

- **At the table from W0.** Representatives join programme governance before use cases are selected, with papers, data and time equal to other members.
- **Agreements in writing.** The dividend allocation (p8), stop list (p7), monitoring boundaries (p18) and role-redesign process (p9) are recorded as collective agreements, not slide decks.
- **Data about staff is negotiated data.** What workforce analytics exist, their aggregation level and their retention are agreed before collection (Volume 8), and audited jointly.
- **Disagreement has a route.** Unresolved issues escalate through agreed machinery with the rollout clock visible to both sides; neither surprise strikes nor surprise go-lives are legitimate moves.
- **Credit is shared publicly.** Agreements that protect staff are announced as agreements, with representatives named as authors - because they are.

EXECUTIVE LENS

A representative who learns of a rollout from a resident's letter will not believe the next assurance. Sequence accordingly.

SERVICE LENS

Formal partnership slows the first decision and speeds every subsequent one.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Keep the agreements in the register; staff trust documents they can reread.

ACCOUNTABILITY

Leadership: named owners, visible decisions, no hiding places

Accountability	Named owner	Answers for
Portfolio and stop list	Chief executive (or equivalent)	The uses that exist, the exclusions that hold, the pauses that happen
Workforce transition	Director of people	Roles, dividend, training, agreements with representatives
Ethics board	Independent chair	Decisions, conditions, refusals - and their enforcement
Public account	Director of communications and service owners jointly	Register currency and plain language (p14)
Trust measurement	Head of insight / chief analyst	Instruments, baselines, publication on schedule (p23)
Incident response	Named duty executive, rota published internally	Speed, candour and repair when trust fails (p26)

- **Leaders use the tools they mandate.** Executives work with the same AI, the same checking discipline and the same override rights as frontline staff - and say what they find, including the failures.
- **Decisions are minuted with dissents.** The record that survives is the one an inquiry reads (p28). Write minutes as if the people affected will read them, because eventually they may.
- **Bad news travels up at full speed.** A culture where incidents are softened at each layer will learn of its worst failure from the media. Reward the bearer; audit the softening.

Accountability that cannot name a person is a mood. **Every use, gate, incident and promise in this volume has a name attached.**

EXECUTIVE LENS

Your diary is a trust instrument: time visibly spent on frontline floors outperforms any town-hall script.

SERVICE LENS

When you pause a popular use case on ethics advice, say so publicly. It is the cheapest trust the programme will ever buy.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Succession is an accountability risk: hand over the register, the agreements and the open conditions, in writing.

TEAM LEADERSHIP

Leading teams through the change: the manager's week

Strategy becomes trust, or doesn't, in team meetings, rosters and one-to-ones. This page equips the layer that carries all three: frontline and middle managers.

Manager practice	Weekly form	What it prevents
Talk about the work, not the tool	Team review of two real cases: one AI success, one caught error	Tools discussed as weather - endured, never examined
Protect checking time	Rostered review slots; queue targets assume them	Rubber-stamping under time pressure (p11)
Surface disagreement	Overrides and near-misses shared without blame in huddles	Silent workarounds and shadow processes
Coach the new craft	One-to-ones on judgement, explanation and evidence skills	Training that never reaches the desk
Watch the load	Aggregate workload and wellbeing check against page 18	Burnout discovered via resignations
Close the loop	Every staff-raised defect gets an answer: fixed, scheduled, or reasoned no	Suggestion schemes that teach staff to stop suggesting



The manager's desk: coaching beside the work, with the case, the evidence and the override in view.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Managers need the same honesty deal as their teams: their own workload and span are part of the change budget.

SERVICE LENS

Promote managers who surface problems early; the alternative incentive is measurable and always taken.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

A manager who cannot explain the stop list cannot lead a team that holds it.

INSIDE THE HOUSE

Fair hiring and deployment: the employer held to its own standard

Government asks residents to trust its AI while using vendors' AI on its own applicants and staff. Any gap between the two standards will be found, published and believed. Internal use is therefore held to the full series standard - stop list included (p7).

The internal standard

- **AI assists, panels decide.** Tools may check application completeness, schedule, and draft structured summaries from the application itself. Shortlisting, scoring and selection are human, recorded and challengeable.
- **Candidates are told.** Job packs state what AI is used at each stage, what data it sees, and how to request human-only handling or an adjustment - offered without detriment.
- **Outcomes are fairness-reviewed like resident decisions.** Progression rates by group at each stage, reviewed on page 13's cadence, with disparities treated as defects.
- **Internal mobility before external automation stories.** Staff displaced from redesigned tasks get first, supported access to the new specialisms (p9, 25) - with training in work time.
- **Vendor tools face the register.** Recruitment systems appear in the public register with their evidence, or they do not run. "The vendor assured us" is not evidence (p27).

> **The mirror test:** read your recruitment AI's register entry as an applicant who was rejected. If it would not satisfy you, it does not ship.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Staff judge the resident-facing programme by the internal one. Sequence the internal standard first where you can.

SERVICE LENS

Keep a human route through every hiring stage and say so in the advert, not the small print.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Audit suppliers' bias testing claims on your own applicant data, under your own ethics board.

MEASUREMENT

Trust and workforce, measured together, published together

Measure	Definition	Watch for
Public trust in the service	Surveyed overall and by group, channel and service, on a fixed instrument	Averages hiding a group whose trust is collapsing
Trust in AI use specifically	Residents who know AI is used, and their confidence by use case	Awareness rising while confidence falls - a register failure (p14)
Explainability test	Sampled residents who can state who decided and how to challenge	Confidence built on not knowing - it will not survive an incident
Staff confidence and skill	Assessed challenge competence (p10) and confidence, by team	Org-wide scores hiding the pilot team that is struggling
Override and agreement rates	By service, read with accuracy (p11)	Very high agreement celebrated instead of investigated
Workforce health	Vacancy, absence, turnover and grievance rates against the page 5 baseline	Productivity claims alongside a quiet exodus of scarce crafts
Human-route requests	Volume and fulfilment time for human-only handling (p16)	Treating requests as failure rather than as the system working

Publish trust, fairness and workforce results **with the savings figures, in the same document**, or expect each audience to believe the worst about the numbers you separated.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Hold the instrument steady; changing the survey mid-programme is how baselines become unfalsifiable.

SERVICE LENS

Report to the ethics board and the public on the same day, from the same tables.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Small-group cuts are published with confidentiality protected and limitations stated - never skipped silently.

ECONOMICS

Trust is cheaper than distrust - and the sums must show it

Cost of distrust	How it appears	Counted as
Rework and repeat contact	Residents who do not believe the first answer call, write and appeal again	Full handling cost of avoidable contact, by cause
Vacancy and agency spiral	Scarce staff leave; agency cover at premium rates, knowledge walking out	Recruitment, agency premium and lost-expertise cost per service
Non-take-up and late engagement	Residents avoid services until crisis makes them expensive	Downstream crisis cost estimated with service leads, stated as estimates
Inquiry and remediation	Failures reconstructed under external scrutiny (p26, 28)	Direct cost and leadership time - the line that ends arguments for underfunding assurance
Savings that survive	Time returned and honestly reallocated (p8-9)	Only the share evidenced at the desk, net of training, review and repair costs

- **Full-cost the trust machinery.** Ethics board, panels, training, register and fairness reviews are programme costs with programme returns - listed in the business case, not discovered in the inquest.
- **Never bank trust twice.** The same saved hour cannot fund the savings line and the quality line. The dividend allocation (p8) is the single ledger.
- **Sunset honestly.** A use case whose trust costs - complaints, overrides-as-workarounds, staff exits - exceed its service gains is retired publicly, as a success of the gate system (p29).

EXECUTIVE LENS

Bring the distrust ledger to budget rounds; finance respects a costed risk more than a valued principle.

SERVICE LENS

Training and ethics lines cut in a savings round reappear as incident costs, with interest.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Measure cost per trusted, correct outcome - the adjectives are the discipline.

STANDARDS

Professional standards: the new crafts, accredited

AI creates public-service crafts that did not exist five years ago: case reviewer, rules steward, fairness analyst, ethics evidence lead. Crafts without standards, grading and progression become duties piled on the willing - and then vacancies.

Craft	Core standard	Progression
AI case reviewer	Assessed challenge competence; sampling and sign-off discipline (p10-11)	Senior reviewer, quality lead
Rules and guidance steward	Legal tracing and version control (Volumes 3, 5)	Service rules owner
Fairness analyst	Statistics, lived-experience methods, defect management (p13)	Portfolio fairness lead
Ethics evidence lead	Gate packs, board secretariat, condition tracking (p12, 29)	Ethics board support, assurance lead
Engagement practitioner	Deliberative methods, accessibility, closing the loop (p15)	Head of public involvement

- **Accreditation is practical.** Assessed on real cases and real records, refreshed on a cycle, portable across services - so skill is a career asset, not a project assignment.
- **Existing professions keep their codes.** Planners, social workers, investigators and lawyers apply their professional standards to AI outputs unchanged; "the tool suggested it" amends no code.
- **Ethics of office still governs.** Impartiality, record-keeping and candour duties extend to prompts, drafts and model outputs exactly as to letters and minutes.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Grade and pay the new crafts before the market does it for you and hires your first cohort.

SERVICE LENS

Put accreditation in job adverts; it signals to applicants that this employer takes the work seriously.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Professional bodies are partners in standard-setting, not audiences for it.

FAILURE

When trust fails: candour first, repair fast, story last

Failure	First 48 hours	Repair
Wrong decisions at scale	Pause the use; duty executive owns it (p20); find affected residents proactively	Correct and compensate before claims arrive; publish scope and cause
Stop-list breach (p7)	Suspend the use; notify affected staff or residents directly	Board review, register entry, disciplinary or contractual consequences as due
Fairness disparity exposed	Acknowledge the data without qualifying it to death; commission independent review	Fix, re-test and publish - with the panel (p13) in the room
Staff trust collapse	Listen formally: representatives and affected teams at the table within days	Written commitments with dates; rollout paused until carried out
Register or public claim proved wrong	Correct it in place, visibly, with the correction dated	Audit every other entry; report the audit, not just the typo

The candour standard

The first public statement names what happened, who is affected, what is being done and when the next update comes - and it comes from the accountable owner, not the press office. Legal advice shapes precision; it does not purchase silence. Every failure is rehearsed yearly in a live drill, including the phone call to the ethics chair and the letter to affected residents, because the first real run cannot be the first practice.

Institutions are forgiven honest failure handled fast. They are not forgiven **discovered concealment** - at any scale, ever.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Pre-draft the hard letters in peacetime; values written under deadline pressure read like it.

SERVICE LENS

Compensation offered proactively costs less - in money and in trust - than compensation extracted.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

After-action reviews are published in summary. Learning kept private will be relearned publicly.

SUPPLIERS

Suppliers and the workforce promise: contracts that keep the deal

Contract term	Requirement
No surveillance features	Staff-monitoring, individual scoring and communication-scanning functions disabled, warranted off, auditable (p7)
Change notification	Model changes notified in advance with retraining impact assessed; no silent updates to tools staff are accountable for
Data terms	Staff and resident data never trains shared models; access minimised; retention and deletion certified; exit export in open formats
Evidence access	Accuracy, fairness and incident data available to the ethics board, auditors and, via the register, the public
Workforce commitments	Supplier implementation plans honour the dividend, training and representative agreements (p8, 19) - delivery pressure is not a waiver
Exit and continuity	Assisted exit, records and training materials transfer; the service can keep its promises to staff after the vendor leaves

- **Demo the discipline, not the demo.** Evaluate how a vendor handles an error, a bias finding and an exit conversation during procurement - those meetings are the product.
- **Reference the register:** a supplier named publicly (p14), with published accuracy, behaves like it. Contract for the naming.
- **Internal tools are not exempt.** HR and productivity suites face the same terms as resident-facing systems (p22).

EXECUTIVE LENS

A vendor who will not warrant surveillance features off has told you they are on.

SERVICE LENS

Keep enough in-house craft (p25) to remain an intelligent customer after signature.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Total the trust costs of exit before signing; a cheap pilot with a hostage workforce is expensive.

SCRUTINY

Scrutiny in public: audit, media and the chamber are features

Public AI will be examined by auditors, journalists, councillors, courts and residents with requests for records. Services that treat scrutiny as attack become secretive, then careless, then caught. Services that build for scrutiny get its protection: errors found early, claims kept honest, legitimacy renewed in public.

The scrutiny standard

- **Write for the future reader.** Gate packs, minutes, decisions and dissents are written as the record they will become (Volume 8). If a sentence would embarrass read aloud in a hearing, the action it describes needs rethinking, not rewording.
- **Answer with the register.** Media and member enquiries are answered from published evidence first (p14); a service whose register is current rarely needs a holding line.
- **Brief the opposition too.** Audit committees and scrutiny panels receive the failures briefing with the successes, from the accountable owner in person.
- **Staff are never the shield.** Leaders front difficult stories personally (p20); frontline staff named in coverage are supported, briefed and never left to face it alone.
- **Corrections compound.** Every external correction is logged, fixed at cause, and counted in the measurement pack (p23) - scrutiny is free assurance, invoiced in pride only.

> **Northbridge (illustrative):** a local paper's records request on selection fairness was answered in four days from the register and fairness files - and the resulting story led with the service's own published disparity and fix. Preparation is not spin; it is what the record being true looks like from outside.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Invite audit early, on your timetable, rather than exclusively on theirs.

SERVICE LENS

The hearing you rehearse for is the incident you have not had yet; rehearse candour, not lines.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Protect the staff member whose honest record creates a difficult headline. That record is the system working.

GATES AND ROADMAP

W0-W5: no use scales without people, ethics and trust evidence

Gate	Question	Evidence required
W0 Mandate	Is this use lawful, wanted and owned?	Named owner; stop-list check signed (p7); workforce and resident engagement opened (p15, 19)
W1 Design	Does it serve staff and residents, honestly?	Principles test (p8); role redesign draft (p9); dividend allocation in writing
W2 Readiness	Are people, ethics and the public account ready?	Training plan rostered (p10); ethics board approval (p12); register entry drafted (p14)
W3 Proof	Does it work - for every group, at real desks?	Accuracy and fairness by group; override behaviour healthy (p11); panel statement filed
W4 Controlled live	Does it hold under load, complaint and scrutiny?	Limited cohort; workload and wellbeing green (p18); incident drill passed (p26)
W5 Scale	Has it earned wider use?	Two cycles of trust and workforce data (p23); agreements honoured; ethics conditions closed

The 24-month roadmap (Northbridge, illustrative)

- **Months 0-6:** workforce baseline, stop list signed, ethics board seated with resident members, register consolidated.
- **Months 7-12:** literacy levels 1-2 across pilot services; role redesigns and dividend agreements in writing; fairness method unified.
- **Months 13-18:** new crafts graded and accredited; engagement panels standing in all services; trust instruments baselined and published.
- **Months 19-24:** whole-portfolio trust and workforce report published with savings; Volume 10 capstone assurance prepared from this evidence.

Shadow before live, **team by team**: a tool proven with one workforce has earned nothing with another until its people are trained, its roles redesigned and its panel has read the outputs.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Hold the gates when the savings target argues. A trust scandal costs more than any pause.

SERVICE LENS

Gate evidence is the public record in waiting; write it that way.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

Skipping W3 proof is the single best predictor of a public failure.

Templates 1-4: copy, complete, file with the gate record

Template 1 - Use Case People and Ethics Mandate (W0)

Use case / service: ___ | Accountable owner: ___ | Stop-list check (p7) signed: ___ | Workforce affected (roles, numbers): ___ | Engagement opened: staff ___ residents ___ | Register entry due: ___

Template 2 - Role Redesign and Dividend Agreement

Role: ___ | Tasks automated / augmented / new: ___ | Hours released (evidenced): ___ | Allocation: quality ___ learning ___ backlog ___ savings ___ | Agreed with representatives (date): ___ | Review date: ___

Template 3 - Ethics Board Submission and Decision

Use case: ___ | Evidence attached: accuracy by group ___ fairness ___ workforce impact ___ engagement record ___ | Board decision: approve / condition / pause / refuse | Conditions, owners, dates: ___ | Dissents recorded: ___ | Register updated: ___

Template 4 - Override and Judgement Log (monthly review)

Service / period: ___ | Outputs: ___ | Overrides: ___ (rate ___) | Top reasons in officers' words: ___ | Tool or data defect found: ___ | Fix owner and date: ___ | High-agreement warning checked: Y/N

Templates set the floor, not the ceiling: a completed template that nobody reads at a gate is stationery. Each template names its gate; the gate reviewer signs against the evidence, not the intention.

EXECUTIVE LENS

Templates belong to service owners; version them like guidance, with dates and change notes.

SERVICE LENS

If a field is always blank, the template is asking the wrong question - fix the template.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

File completed templates where an auditor or a panel member will look first.

Templates 5-8 and the assurance checklist

Template 5 - Fairness Finding and Fix Record

Review period: ___ | Outcome compared, by group: ___ | Disparity found: ___ | Hypothesis: data / model / process / practice | Fix or board-signed acceptance: ___ | Re-test date: ___ | Published: ___

Template 6 - Public Engagement Record

Stage / gate: ___ | Who was in the room (and who was missing): ___ | Views heard, including opposition: ___ | What changed: ___ | What was refused, and the published reason: ___ | Loop closed in writing: ___

Template 7 - Complaint and Trust Repair Record

Resident / case: ___ | What happened: ___ | Remedy completed before explanation: ___ | Specific apology given: ___ | Cause code: ___ | Systemic fix owner and date: ___ | Follow-up result: ___

Template 8 - Trust Incident and Candour Log

Incident: ___ | Detected how / when: ___ | Use paused: Y/N | Affected people notified directly: ___ | First public statement (owner, time): ___ | Repair completed: ___ | Register entry: ___ | Drill lesson filed: ___

Assurance checklist

- Stop list signed, taught and breach-logged (p7)
- Role redesigns and dividend agreements in writing (p8-9)
- Training assessed before sign-off rights granted (p10-11)
- Ethics decisions, conditions and refusals published (p12)
- Fairness findings fixed or board-accepted, re-tests dated (p13)
- Register current, plain-language tested, failures included (p14)
- Trust and workforce results published with savings (p23-24)

EXECUTIVE LENS

The checklist is the audit trail's table of contents; keep the evidence behind every line.

SERVICE LENS

Assurance samples real cases and real rosters, not presentations.

ACCOUNTABILITY LENS

A checklist that always passes is measuring the checklist.

GOLDEN RULES

20 Golden Rules for workforce, ethics and public trust

1. AI prepares, drafts and flags; people serve, decide and answer.
2. Trust is a stock: built by kept promises, spent by hidden ones.
3. No decision about a person's livelihood, selection or standing is automated - inside the house or outside it.
4. Subtraction before addition: work leaves the day before tools join it.
5. The time AI saves is allocated in advance, in writing, with staff representatives.
6. Nobody signs what they cannot challenge; training precedes access, assessment precedes sign-off.
7. The override is one action, needs no permission, and its reasons are read as evidence about the tool first.
8. Very high agreement with AI is a warning to investigate, not a success to celebrate.
9. Ethics review can say no, sometimes does, and publishes that it did.
10. A fairness disparity is a defect: owned, fixed, re-tested - or publicly reasoned.
11. Say it before you are asked: uses, limits, errors and failures, on your own timetable.
12. Never say the computer decided. Name the person, the evidence and the route to challenge.
13. The human route is always open, without penalty, and its use is published.
14. Remedy before explanation; apologise specifically; thank the complainant who was right.
15. Never target fewer complaints. Target fewer causes.
16. No surveillance scoring of staff or residents - excluded, not minimised.
17. Leaders use the tools they mandate, front the failures personally, and never shield behind frontline staff.
18. Publish trust, fairness and workforce results with the savings, in the same document.
19. When trust fails: pause, tell affected people directly, repair proactively, publish the cause.
20. Write every record for the future reader - the auditor, the panel, the resident, the inquiry.

Next: **Volume 10 - Government Capstone and Assurance**: the whole portfolio, tested as one system, and the licence to scale earned in public.

Northbridge City and County is a fictional composite. All figures marked illustrative are examples for adaptation, not benchmarks. Adapt thresholds to your own law, labour agreements and risk appetite.